

INTERCEPTOR

ADVANCED FLIGHT MANEUVERS: IN DEPTH REVIEW

Moving beyond using the Basic Rules, Advanced Flight Maneuvers (AFM) can be found in the *Interceptor Core Rulebook*, pg. 102. Using them can mean the difference between getting off a shot or waiting until next round for better positioning. In the Basic Rules, all mounted weapons only fire in a straight line. This can make lining up shots difficult but encourages using maneuvering to your advantage. However, it does over-emphasize the importance of Initiative as well. The side which loses Initiative is almost guaranteed to have a fighter who gets no attack, especially in a straight up skirmish.

Pilots may worry that every time they line up a shot, they face an attack. They are right, but the higher difficulties of a pilot spinning around for a rear attack may make the pilot think twice, especially if they are moving quickly. Advanced Flight Maneuvers allow pilots to attempt attacks even when they are off the standard direct firing line. The risk is that the pilot may lose control of their craft when trying to line up the attack, which can be deadly if they fail to recover at the end of the round.



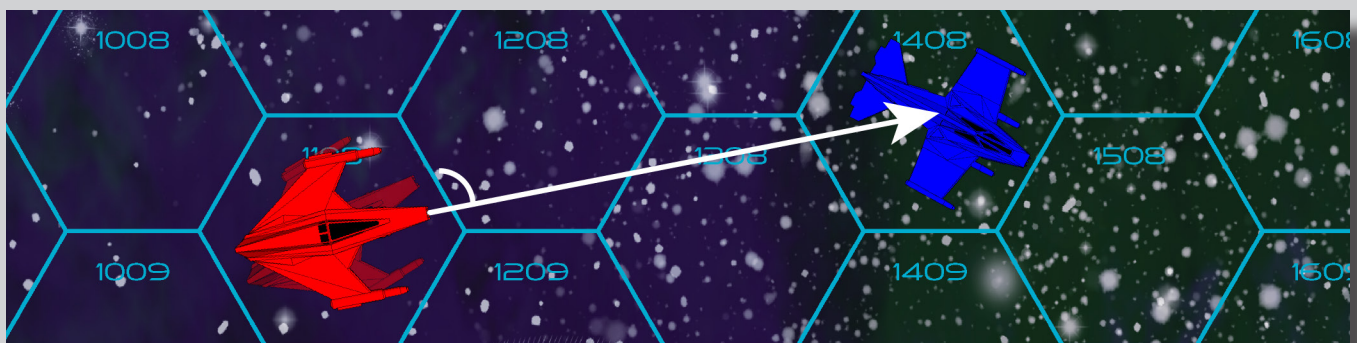
BASE DIFFICULTY

This is a clarification on how lining up the AFM shot works. In the *Interceptor Core Rulebook*, the examples only show fighters lining up exactly to hex facings. This is not necessary to perform an AFM Test; a fighter does not have to rotate "exact" hex faces to line up with a target.

If the fighter does not need to rotate a complete hex (Example 1) it only uses the base Difficulty 1 for the AFM Test. However, if the rotation is exactly on the line between the two fighters (Example 2), it is considered a hex facing for the purpose of calculating the AFM Test Difficulty. If it becomes necessary to measure to determine the rotation and facing needed, a straight line between the center of the hexes containing the two fighters can be used for an exact measurement as illustrated in the examples.

Base Difficulty Example 1

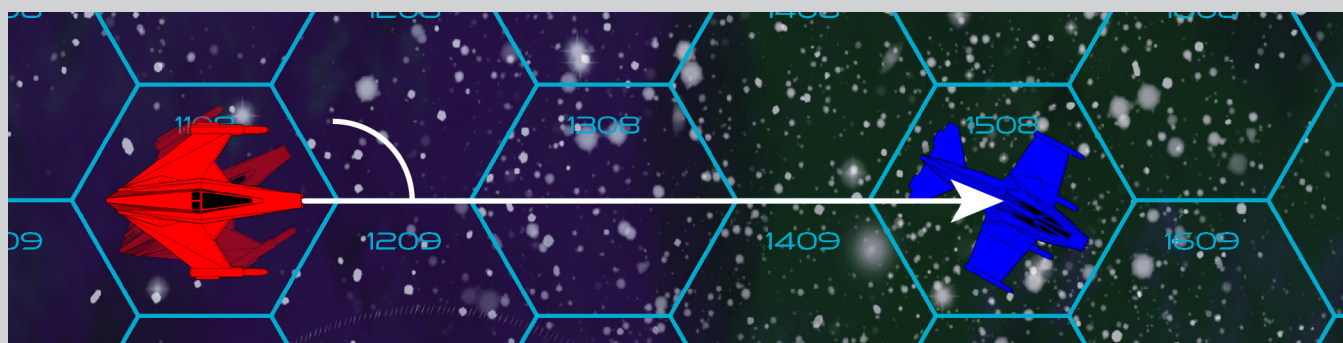
The Dart (red) rotates for an AFM Test against the Revenant (blue). It only needs to rotate slightly to line up the shot, and the AFM Test has a base Difficulty 1.



BASE DIFFICULTY CONTINUED

Base Difficulty Example 2

Here the Dart needs to rotate slightly more to line up the shot, placing it right on the hex point halfway between facings. In this case it counts as rotating a facing, so the AFM Test has a base Difficulty 2.

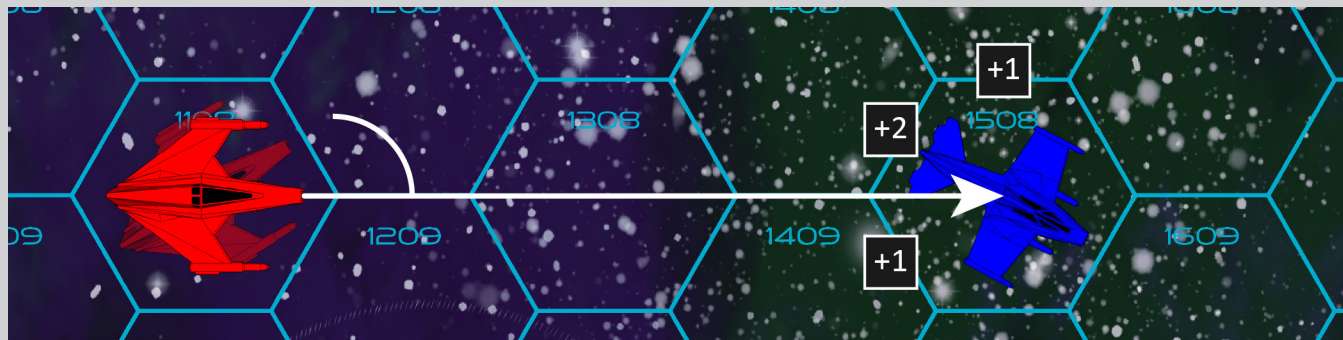


ATTACK VECTOR MODIFIER

Whenever the AFM attack lines up on a hex point between two modifiers, the worst of the two is used as the dice penalty for the attack.

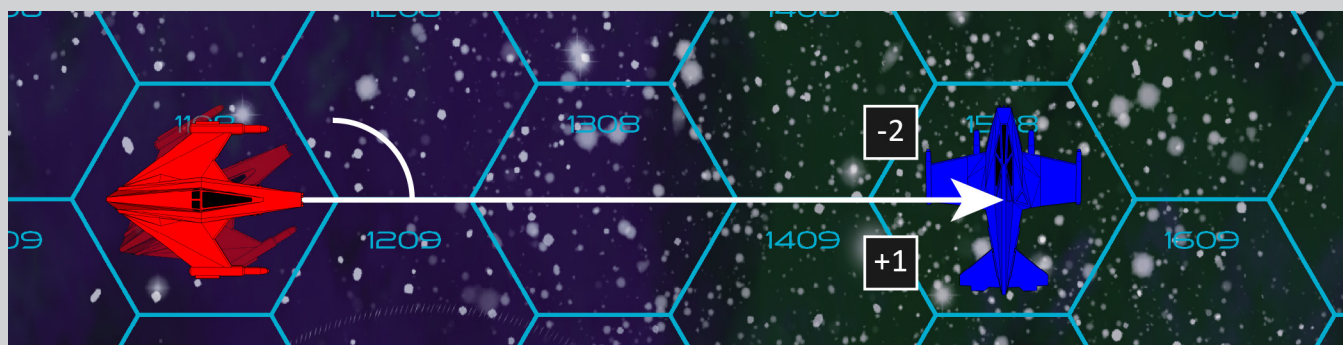
Attack Vector Modifier Example 1

The Dart is lined up between Attack Vector Modifier of +1 or +2. It uses the +1 dice modifier.



Attack Vector Modifier Example 2

In this Example, the Dart is lined up between Attack Vector Modifiers -2 and +1. Here it would use the -2 dice modifier rather than the +1. A difficult shot that may leave the pilot waiting to line up a better position rather than risk going out of control for a mediocre shot.



WATCH YOUR SPEED

Make sure you keep your Velocity in mind prior to attempting these maneuvers. Higher Velocity means the AFM Test Difficulty increases. If you manage to go Seriously Out of Control while clipping along at max thrust in your *Bolt*, you are likely to have a bad day.

Once you get into a furball, there is a good chance your Velocity will be lower and there will be a lot more targets to choose from. Line up on them as best as you can to keep that rotation down.

USING LONG-RANGE FIGHTERS

Fighters that have exclusively long and extreme-range weapons such as the Terran Commonwealth's *Trebuchet* or Callistonian Empire's *Apparition* can use AFM to stay out at range and have the opportunity to engage several targets at once. These fighters can use this to their advantage and have a larger zone of coverage to protect their wingmates.

DEALING WITH DAMAGE

Most fighters have the Agility to handle any AFM we pilots can throw at them. Until they take a few hits. Then all bets are off. Monitor the Agility and Control systems of your fighter. Remember, any AFM Test with a Difficulty higher than the fighter's current Agility cannot be attempted and damage Controls are going to make it a lot harder to keep things pointed in the right direction.



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